wonder whether there's any good reason to choose the `Startup` approach over `WebApplication`. As always, the answer is "It depends," but one possible reason is so that you can customize your `IHostBuilder`.

30.4 Creating a custom IHostBuilder

As you saw in section 30.2, the default way to work with a `Startup` class in ASP.NET Core is to use the `Host.CreateDefaultBuilder()` method. This opinionated helper method sets up many defaults for your app. It is analogous to the `WebApplication .CreateBuilder()` method in that way.

However, you don't have to use the `CreateDefaultBuilder` method to create an `IHostBuilder` instance: you can directly create a `HostBuilder` instance and customize it from scratch if you prefer. Before you start doing that, though, it's worth seeing some of the things the `CreateDefaultBuilder` method gives you and what they're used for. You may then consider customizing the default `HostBuilder` instance instead of creating a completely bespoke instance.

NOTE You can use `Host.CreateDefaultBuilder()` in .NET 7 even if you're not using ASP.NET Core by installing the Microsoft.Extensions.Hosting package. You'll learn how to create non-HTTP applications using the generic host in chapter 34.

The defaults chosen by `CreateDefaultBuilder` are ideal when you're initially setting up an app, but as your application grows, you may find you need to break it apart and tinker with some of the internals. The following listing shows a rough overview of the